Although the sources of TTP financing were not very hard to identify, the intelligence reporting in this regard had been mostly insufficient and inaccurate, especially Al Qaeda's funding to TTP which could not be detected and blocked. The evolution of TTP, from scattered groups of tribesmen, that harboured and sheltered Al Qaeda runaways from Afghanistan, to its final form in December 2007, was much due to Al Qaeda's financial support.

According to some reports, TTP started facing funds shortage in 2011. According to military sources, it was mainly due to stringent controls the Pakistan Army had put in place. Another reason stated for the dearth of TTP funds was the blows the Arab Al Qaeda had faced in the region due to a concerted campaign against them by the US forces stationed in Afghanistan and the drone attacks that shattered its command and control in the tribal areas of Pakistan. As an intelligence official disclosed, 'Al-Qaeda is on the run now. . .most of the private Arab money to the TTP used to come through them. That has evaporated now.'

Moreover, the drug money from Afghanistan also soaked away to a large extent after tight controls by the US-led forces on the border, following their operations against the Afghan Taliban in Helmand and Kandahar (Khan, 2011).

PUBLIC SUPPORT AND SYMPATHY FOR TTP AND AL QAEDA

The majority of Pakistani Muslims, irrespective of their sectarian affiliations, do not want mullahs or religious extremists to dictate their lives according to their strict version of Islam or to rule them. They had been expressing their desire for moderate rulers in polls throughout Pakistan's history. In the 2008 general election, in areas like Swat, where TNSM and later on the TTP had much influence, seven out of the total eight national assembly seats were won by the Awami National Party (ANP), a secular political party (*The Nation*, 2009). The religious parties got 2 per cent votes across Pakistan. JI abstained from the 2008 general elections, had it participated, the votes for religious parties would not have crossed 4 per cent, as the history showed. As the people of Pakistan have deep affection for the Muslim countries and express their deep concern on issues like Palestine, Iraq, Afghanistan and Kashmir, the TTP elements from FATA and Swat exploited the favourable sentiments